SMOKE & THUNDER

FIREARMS FOR FIFTH EDITION

JOSHUA E. OHMER

Add Detailed Firearms to Your Campaign
From Any Era, Historical, Modern, or Futuristic

GUILD

Credits

Designer: Joshua Ohmer
Graphic Designer: Joshua Ohmer
Template: Simple Microsoft Word Template by Laura Hirsbrunner
Cover Illustrator: Image sourced from pxhere.com, under a Creative Commons license.
Interior Illustrators: Seamless parchment texture by IcyCatElf, handwriting by Nile, page decorator by AnnaliseArt, used under license. All other interior illustrations used under Creative Commons licensing and sourced from Wikimedia Commons and pxhere.com; MS Word filters applied.
Special Thanks: To my long-suffering wife, partners, and friends who have listened to me obsess over this project for way too long. Y'all are the best.
Playtesters: Rachel Rennie, Heather Bell, Peter Hassel, and Crystal Speck

ON THE COVER

Photograph of an ornate "Philadelphia Derringer"—The engraved spelling indicates that this little pistol was one of many knockoffs of the original designer, Henry Deringer, Jr., who had only one "r" in his name.
CC0 Public Domain. Free for personal and commercial use. Sourced from https://pxhere.com/en/photo/661769

A Note from the Designer

This book is a labor of love. I have played D&D for over thirty years, and written rules content for most of that time, but this is my first fully polished content that I've felt ready to publish. I hope it will be the first of several. If feedback is positive, I have possible bonus content in mind for this book, as well as a second volume of Smoke & Thunder, and other unrelated ideas. Regardless of how it is received, I'm happy to finally release this work, and I hope you will enjoy playing with it as much as I've enjoyed creating it.

Disclaimer: This work describes firearms in a fantasy setting. Gun violence is a genuine issue and should be treated with respect. Please be responsible.

DUNGEONS & DRAGONS, D&D, Wizards of the Coast, Forgotten Realms, Ravenloft, Eberron, the dragon ampersand, Ravnica, Spelljammer, and all other Wizards of the Coast product names, and their respective logos are trademarks of Wizards of the Coast in the USA and other countries.

This work contains material that is copyright Wizards of the Coast and/or other authors. Such material is used with permission under the Community Content Agreement for Dungeon Masters Guild.

All other original material in this work is copyright 2022 by **Joshua Ohmer** and published under the Community Content Agreement for Dungeon Masters Guild.

Table of Contents

Introduction: Why Smoke & Thunder? 3
Design Philosophy 3
Including Firearms in Your Game 3

Chapter 1: The Development of Firearms 4
Firearm Eras 4
- Late Medieval Period 4
- Renaissance Era 4
- Age of Empire 5
- Early Industrial Era 5
- High Industrial Era 5
- Proto–Energy Age 5
- Advanced Energy Age 5

Chapter 2: Equipment 6
Firearms 6
- Weapon Proficiency 6
- Weapon Properties 6
- Weapons Of Each Era 7
- Types of Ammunition 10

Armor and Shields 12
- Renaissance Armor 12
- High Industrial Armor 12
- Proto–Energy Age Armor 12
- Advanced Energy Age Armor 13

Support Gear 13

Chapter 3: Character Options 15
New Fighting Styles 15
New Feats 15
- Autofire Expert 15
- Gun Fu 15
- Handgun Expert 15
- Rifle Master 15
- Trick Shooting 15
- Two Birds With One Stone 15

New Spells 16

Chapter 4: Optional Rules 17
Combat Actions 17
- Aim 17
- Provide Cover Fire 17

Advanced Rules 17
- Ballistics 17
- Stray Fire 17
- Ammunition and Flexibility 18
- Damage Realism 18
- Environmental Hazards 18

Afterword 19

Introduction: Why Smoke & Thunder?

Many rule sets for guns already exist for D&D. The intent of Smoke & Thunder is to make firearms accessible to characters of any class, across a wide range of time periods and genres, without turning them into the only practical weapon choices. My home campaign is set in a world with a variety of cultures and technology levels, much like the worlds of Spelljammer, so it was important to me to achieve some degree of balance between firearms and the usual medieval fantasy weapons, as well as between early and more advanced guns.

This is not to say that firearms, particularly later ones, won't have advantages over traditional weapons. They certainly do! But in 5e's spirit of bounded accuracy, they get better by degrees rather than leaps. Hopefully, this will make it simple to drop them into just about any setting or scenario with minimal difficulty. In short, Smoke & Thunder is an attempt to balance all eras' weapons against each other—to design guns that blow away the bad guys without blowing up your game!

Design Philosophy

One of the major challenges of modeling firearms in D&D is how the game handles injuries. The abstraction of hit points allows characters to survive many more blows, stabs, and cuts and keep going, yet we're used to thinking of guns as outright deadly. In the real world, wounds from blades and bows can sometimes be just as life-threatening as those from bullets. Occasionally more so. With that in mind, the firearms presented here have damage ranges like those of other weapons—mostly single dice, with a few exceptions. This approach allows for exciting clashes between characters from different technological backgrounds and lets players choose their weapons based on character concept rather than a need for mechanical optimization.

When it comes to how specific to get with different weapons, I made another firm decision. Just as the *Player's Handbook* doesn't attempt to include every specific type of sword or polearm throughout history, Smoke & Thunder mostly abstracts firearms into general types, while including a few historical oddities for variety. For example, although muzzleloaders are treated differently from more-modern weapons in this guide, no attempt has been made to further distinguish between matchlock and flintlock firing mechanisms. A revolver is a revolver here, no matter if it's a Colt or a S&W. Submachine gun stats can equally represent a tommy-gun, an Uzi, or a P-90. In other words, these weapon stats are meant to be representative, not exhaustive.

Including Firearms in Your Game

As with any optional set of rules, it is entirely up to the DM to decide whether and how to incorporate firearms (and the other contents of this book) into their campaign. Deciding how rare or common firearms are can be a major decision that affects the flavor of your game.

Smoke & Thunder divides firearms into rough historical eras, so one approach is to use only weapons from a particular era, making the rest of the time periods off-limits. Some campaigns may wish to mix two or more eras, either because they are set on a technological cusp, or because the setting is deliberately anachronistic. Spelljammer and steampunk settings may be particularly ripe for mixing gunpowder with futuristic ray guns, for example.

Here are a few things to consider:

- The purchase prices in this book assume that metallurgy and manufacturing techniques in your game world are reasonably like those of the analogous real-world historical era. The costs are also intended to reflect a market where the weapons are actively manufactured. Any weapon that is new or unfamiliar technology will generally cost significantly more, if it can be purchased at all.
- The earliest firearms should integrate easily into most styles of play, as they deal comparable damage to other ranged weapons. The benefits of early firearms are mostly that they have longer ranges than comparable weapons and their ease of use (many are Simple Weapons).
- Modern-era firearms present the most challenges in terms of potentially unbalancing a campaign. Exceptionally long ranges and special attack options make some of them akin to magic items. The costs of the most powerful such weapons are high enough that beginning characters may have to save up to buy them.
- Near-future firearms are distinguished by the greatest mechanical complexity. Many of them deal energy-based damage types, and some offer ways to impose Conditions on their targets.
- Distant future weapons don't have a lot of rule complexity, but nearly all of them deal energy damage, which can make some monsters easier to defeat. That's no different than a spellcaster with a cantrip, though.

Ultimately, this comes down to what type of story you and your group want to tell. In a modern-inspired setting, there are a few ways a DM might choose to either ease or restrict PCs' access to guns. If you as the DM feel that starting out with expensive weapons is right for the type of campaign you want to run, you can either increase characters' starting money or simply grant them the weapons that you think they should have. The latter choice works particularly well if the PCs are employed by military, mercenary, or law enforcement agencies that would be likely to equip them for missions. And don't forget, as a balancing factor, that if the player-characters have modern guns, their adversaries probably do as well.

If you wish to limit the party's access to powerful arms, while still acknowledging that such weapons exist within the setting, you can limit the legality of certain firearms, or increase their costs even higher. You could even entirely remove the option to buy them on the open market, treating them much like magic items. Perhaps in your setting, while guns are not themselves magical, powder—and therefore ammunition—is similar to a magic potion. Restricting the availability of ammunition is especially effective if the PCs capture weapons from defeated foes. If they can't easily purchase ammo, they'll have to make difficult choices about rationing what they have.

Chapter 1: The Development of Firearms

Such I hold to be the genuine use of gunpowder: that it makes all men tall.

—Thomas Carlyle, *Sartor Restartus*

The invention of firearms followed the ancient discovery of black powder, later called gunpowder. At its most basic, black powder is a mixture of charcoal, sulfur, and saltpeter—a mineral arising from bat guano, and often mined from caves. Black powder is quite flammable and explosive but must be kept dry to be effective.

The formula and production methods for the powder were originally closely guarded secrets, which could be an interesting source of conflict in a medieval or fantasy setting. The precise composition and manufacture of gunpowder have evolved through the centuries, as have the means of loading and igniting it to fire a weapon.

A piece of ammunition for any firearm that shoots a physical projectile (as opposed to a beam of energy or gout of flame) is called a round. Early rounds are *literally* round and may also be called balls, musket balls, bullets (or pellets for some weapons), and must be loaded into the barrel with a small amount of black powder and usually wadding made of rags or paper to hold them in place. The rounds, powder, and wadding are sold together as a single item in these rules, allowing players to simply track shots instead of having to buy and track these components separately.

In later eras, the combination of gunpowder and one or more projectiles into a single object is called a cartridge. The projectile may be either a bullet or a quantity of pellets called shot—in the latter case, the cartridge is referred to as a shotgun shell or shotshell. All cartridge ammunition in these rules is considered either handgun cartridges, rifle cartridges, or shotshells. Some cartridge ammunition can be purchased with special properties, found in the Ammunition Table. After firing, a spent cartridge leaves an empty casing, which is either ejected upon firing or as part of reloading.

Futuristic firearms use a variety of specialized types of ammunition, as listed in the weapon tables. Many advanced firearms use replaceable power cells, which are a type of battery that stores enough energy to generate a given number of shots. Disruption and phase weapons have integrated power cells which are self-recharging. (How they do this is up to your imagination. They may hold tiny fusion reactors, efficient solar cells, or something more exotic, but for rule purposes it doesn't matter.)

Firearm Eras

Smoke & Thunder divides technology into several historical eras, beginning with the late medieval period. Of course, not all firearms within a given period were invented at the same time and might not all be available in your campaign world. As technology progresses, it is common for a few of the older types of weapons to remain in use. Each era builds on the range of options previously available. The following are rough outlines of the historical periods used throughout these rules, along with suggested role-playing genres for each era.

Late Medieval Period

Late 13th to 14th Centuries

During this period in history, firearms gradually supplanted bows on the battlefield, largely due to requiring less training to be effective. Although the single-use fire lance predates it (see explosives, in Smoke & Thunder 2), the hand cannon or handgonne is widely regarded as the first true non-artillery firearm. Essentially just a miniature cannon mounted on a long handle, it suffered from poor accuracy and range, and was in turn replaced by the longer-barreled arquebus, which saw much more widespread use. Firearms of this era relied on variations of a lit match or matchlock mechanism for firing.

Suggested for adding some bang to medieval fantasy adventure or wuxia martial arts.

Renaissance Era

15th to 17th Centuries

While the arquebus continued to be widely used by regular soldiers, well-trained musketeers became the elite gunners of the Renaissance. Muskets and pistols at this time featured improved firing mechanisms—first wheellock and later flintlock—as well as better accuracy than their predecessors.

Suggested for warring principalities; swashbuckling high adventure; Age of Exploration campaigns; Elizabethan style intrigue.

What About Spelljammer?

With the recent release of Spelljammer: Adventures in Space, and the limited firearm options for Giff characters, there's a fair chance that's what you're here for. Once again, this is going to be a call for the DM, but since Giff are usually pictured with some type of musket or blunderbuss, Renaissance and Age of Empire are likely your best bets for spacefaring fantasy, but Late Medieval would be fine to use as well. If you want to go wild, you might toss in shotguns from the Early Industrial Era for the irony of having hippos turned big game hunters.

In the vastness of Wildspace and the multiverse, it's likely that other cultures have discovered the wonders of black powder and firearms, as well, so it may seem strange that not everyone uses them. There may be many explanations for why we don't see these weapons in the hands of more armies across the planes, but magic may be to blame in more ways than one. When you can hire a wizard to control the battlefield, investing in innovative technologies may seem frivolous to many rulers. Some peoples may consider firearms a gift from the gods, closely guarding the secrets of their construction and use.

On the other hand, just imagine an army of formians with rifles, or mind flayers with phase pistols…

Age of Empire

18th to mid-19th Centuries

Muskets and pistols continued to be the most common weapons of this era. Other guns arose, however, such as the pellet-firing blunderbuss and its smaller cousin, the dragon (hence the term dragoon for certain elite cavalry who wielded them). Some of the first multi-shot firearms were invented during this period, most famously those known as pepperboxes.

Also notable is the increasing use throughout this period of the bayonet, typically affixed to a musket as a backup weapon. Toward the end of the era, the invention of rifling led to far more accurate muskets, used on many global battlefields.

Suggested for high seas pirate adventure; Revolutionary and Napoleonic warfare; Gothic horror; American Civil War battles

Where Does Steampunk Fit?

Steampunk—the popular genre of speculative fiction involving airships, mad science, and derring-do—often features a variety of firearms. While Smoke & Thunder doesn't specifically cover the many varieties of Victorian flavored retro-futurism, using these firearms rules in a steampunk setting is easy enough to do. The basic weapons of such a world will most likely be those of either the Age of Empire or the Early Industrial Era, but weapons from any of the subsequent eras could easily be re-skinned as marvels of the age.

Strap a light handgun to a character's forearm and call it a wrist cannon or rename the machine gun a portable Gatling gun. The ion rifle and sonic gun are already just as right for steampunk as they are for cyberpunk. Even advanced energy age weapons can be a perfect fit for the genre, especially if you give them flamboyant names like caloric ray gun, galvanic blaster, etheric phaser, and molecular disruptor!

Often in steampunk settings, these advanced weapons will be unique inventions, created by PCs or found in the hands of major villains, but the style of the genre varies widely. DMs should guide their players in choosing weapons for such a setting.

Early Industrial Era

Late 19th to early 20th Centuries

This era marks the transition to cartridge firearms, wherein the bullet and the gunpowder are contained in a single metal cartridge, allowing much faster reloading and firing. Rifled barrels also increased range and accuracy. The blunderbuss is a notable holdover from earlier times throughout the period, particularly in isolated areas.

Suggested for Wild West adventures; Victorian sleuthing; Great War trench warfare.

High Industrial Era

Early 20th Century to present

All the early industrial firearm types are still popular up to the present day. Modern warfare has added to those a vast array of added weapon types and features, particularly semi-automatic and fully automatic firearms — which are represented here by the rapid-fire and spray properties.

Suggested for Prohibition mobsters; noir detective mysteries; World War II campaigns; Cold War spy adventures; crime procedurals, or anything else set in the modern era.

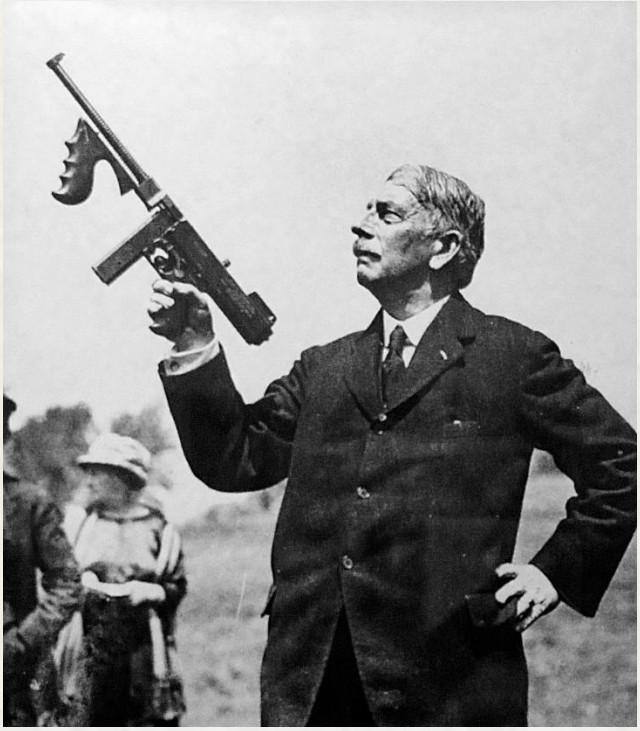


Figure 1 Thompson and his gun.

Proto–Energy Age

Near future

Weapons in this category include the earliest attempts at energy-based combat technology. Many of them have special rules. These weapons are mostly speculative, but many are inspired by real-world designs. For example, the pain gun and sonic gun are hand-held versions of so-called "active denial" systems used by some law enforcement agencies for crowd control, while the gauss rifle is a miniaturized version of experimental naval artillery. All these designs could represent cutting-edge government hardware or gritty, near-future street warfare.

Suggested for present-day special ops or super-spies, cyberpunk and other dystopian future settings.

Advanced Energy Age

Distant future and space opera settings

Science fiction and science fantasy supply a never-ending variety of ray guns, and those included here are some of the most popular types. Laser, blaster, disruption, and phase technologies are well represented in popular media. Many universes will only include one or two of these technologies, or perhaps a different one for each major spacefaring civilization.

Suggested for exploring alien worlds, fighting galactic empires, or engaging in swashbuckling space piracy.

Chapter 2: Equipment

This chapter forms the core of Smoke & Thunder. It begins with firearms, then ammunition, armor, and then covers gun-related support gear. As a general guideline, most equipment related to earlier eras than that in which the campaign is set can still be acquired, although anything from two eras earlier may be considered an oddity or rare antique.

Firearms

The category "firearms" is a group of ranged weapons, just as bows are in the core rules. Firearms function just like other ranged weapons. When making a firearm attack, apply your Dexterity modifier to both the attack and damage rolls.

This section presents rules for using firearms in D&D combat. Unless otherwise noted, these rules are additions to, not replacements for, the combat rules in the *Player's Handbook.*

A firearm attack expends one or more pieces of loaded ammunition. Removable magazines and power cells hold multiple pieces of ammunition. For simplicity, differing calibers and powder loads are ignored in these rules (just as different lengths of shafts and types of points are ignored for arrows and crossbow bolts).

Weapon Proficiency

Like other weapons, all firearms are classified as either simple or martial weapons. There is no special requirement for being proficient with firearms, though your DM might decide that they are unfamiliar to characters who are encountering them for the first time. That could mean that player-characters need to spend a little time training with these weapons before being considered proficient. Typically, an adventurer should be able to pick up the necessary familiarity in a day or so.

A few specific martial firearms are suited for adding to the rogue's proficiency list, as noted in the firearms tables. Also, due to the extreme ease of use of one-hand simple firearms, the arcane spellcasting classes—artificer, bard, sorcerer, warlock, and wizard—are also proficient with those weapons, as noted in the tables.

Druids and Firearm Use: Although druids are proficient with all simple weapons, including simple firearms, many of them eschew firearms as disruptions to the natural order. Although this isn't universal, players of druid characters may want to give special consideration to how they view firearms and whether or in what circumstances they might wield them.

Weapon Properties

The following section lists the weapon properties that are relevant to firearms, including both new properties (marked with an asterisk) and properties from the Core Rules. Minor modifications to existing properties are shown in italics.

Ammunition. You can use a weapon that has the ammunition property to make a ranged attack only if you have ammunition to fire from the weapon. Each time you attack with the weapon, you expend one piece of ammunition *that is already loaded in the weapon. Firearm ammunition is destroyed when fired and cannot be recovered after the battle.*

If you use a weapon that has the ammunition property to make a melee attack, you treat the weapon as an improvised weapon (see "Improvised Weapons" in the PHB).

Heavy. Creatures that are Small or Tiny have disadvantage on attack rolls with heavy weapons. A heavy weapon's size and bulk make it too large for a Small or Tiny creature to use effectively. *In addition, heavy weapons are extremely difficult or impossible to conceal on one's body.*

Light. A light weapon is small and easy to handle, making it ideal for use when fighting with two weapons. *In addition, light weapons are particularly easy to conceal.*

Loading. Because of the time needed to load this weapon, you can fire only one piece of ammunition from it when you use an action, bonus action, or reaction to fire it, regardless of the number of attacks you can normally make.

***Non-lethal.** The damage dealt by this weapon incapacitates rather than killing the target. If an attack from this weapon reduces a creature to 0 hit points, the creature falls unconscious and is stable.

Range. A weapon that can be used to make a ranged attack has a range shown *in a separate column of the tables*. The range lists two numbers. The first is the weapon's normal range in feet, and the second indicates the weapon's long range. When attacking a target beyond normal range, you have disadvantage on the attack roll. You can't attack a target beyond the weapon's long range.

What's With These Ranges?

Whereas traditional ranged weapons have a maximum range four times longer than their normal range, most firearms have a maximum that is five or ten times their normal range, depending on whether they are one- or two-handed. This reflects the exceptional distance that a supersonic projectile can travel, while keeping normal ranges that are representative of the difficulty of aiming in close combat. If guns had normal ranges only a quarter of their long range, nearly all combats would occur within their normal range.

***Rapid-fire.** As a bonus action when you attack with this weapon, you may spend an extra piece of ammunition from the weapon to give yourself advantage on the attack roll.

***Recharge N.** A few unusual firearms use integrated power sources for ammunition, which hold N charges and recharge over time. Each attack uses one charge. As an action, you can cycle the weapon to regain 2 charges. All charges are regained when you finish a short or long rest.

***Reload N.** A reload weapon may hold up to N pieces of ammunition at a time. You can use an action or bonus action to reload any firearm. Reloading requires a free hand.

***Scattershot.** This weapon's ammunition spreads out as it travels. Attacks against a target at long range do not

have disadvantage but cannot gain advantage. Targets at long range take half damage from the attack.

Special. A weapon with the special property has unusual rules governing its use, explained in the weapon's description (see "Special Weapons" later in this chapter).

***Spray.** When you take the Attack action with this weapon, you may use a bonus action to fire a spray of extra shots. This special attack deals the weapon's damage to all creatures and objects in a line the length of the weapon's normal range. Targets can make a Dexterity saving throw to take half damage (DC 8+ Proficiency +Dex modifier). This special attack requires and consumes ten pieces of ammunition.

Two-Handed. This weapon requires two hands when you attack with it. *(Note that in some instances in the following tables, two-handed has been abbreviated as "2-hand" for space.)*

Weapons Of Each Era

The tables below list firearms for each era by their proficiency type. Simple weapons that are appropriate for adding to the bard, sorcerer, warlock, and wizard proficiency lists are marked with a double dagger (‡), while martial weapons that may be added to the rogue's list are marked with a dagger (†).

Each table has two added columns not found in the *Player's Handbook*. First, since all firearms have the ammunition property, instead of listing it for every weapon, there is a column showing what type of ammunition is used for that firearm. (See "Types of Ammunition" later in this chapter.) Following the ammunition type, in parentheses, is a tag noting the weapon's style of magazine (muzzleloading, internal, or removable). This has no special rules meaning, but other features may refer to weapons with a certain type of magazine. Next to this is a column for range, using the standard "normal/long" notation in feet.

Several weapons in the Proto–Energy Age table have effects that apply in addition to damage on a successful hit. For ease of reference, a plus (+) symbol next to the damage type acts as an added reminder of these special properties which are detailed in the "Special Weapons" section.

Table 2.1—Late Medieval Firearms (and Repeating Crossbow)

Simple Weapons	Cost	Damage	Weight	Ammunition/Magazine	Range	Additional Properties
Arquebus	30 gp	1d10 piercing	9 lbs.	Powder (muzzleloading)	40/400	Reload 1, two-handed
Hand cannon (aka, handgonne)	20 gp	2d6 piercing	10 lbs.	Powder (muzzleloading)	30/150	Reload 1, scattershot, two-handed
Martial Weapons						
Crossbow, repeating †	75 gp	1d6 piercing	7 lbs.	Bolts (internal)	60/240	Reload 8, two-handed

Table 2.2—Renaissance Firearms

Simple Weapons	Cost	Damage	Weight	Ammunition/Magazine	Range	Additional Properties
Blunderbuss, long	40 gp	2d6 piercing	6 lbs.	Powder (muzzleloading)	30/300	Reload 1, scattershot, two-handed
Musket pistol ‡	20 gp	1d8 piercing	2 lbs.	Powder (muzzleloading)	20/100	Reload 1
Martial Weapons						
Blunderbuss pistol (aka, dragon)	30 gp	1d12 piercing	3 lbs.	Powder (muzzleloading)	20/100	Reload 1, scattershot
Musket, carbine †	45 gp	1d10 piercing	9 lbs.	Powder (muzzleloading)	40/400	Reload 1, two-handed
Musket, long †	50 gp	1d12 piercing	12 lbs.	Powder (muzzleloading)	60/600	Heavy, reload 1, two-handed
Musket, repeater	400 gp	1d10 piercing	13 lbs.	Powder (internal)	50/500	Heavy, loading, reload 15, two-handed
Musket, sword †	35 gp	1d8 piercing (1d4 w/ blade)	3 lbs.	Powder (muzzleloading)	20/100	Reload 1, special

Table 2.3—Age of Empire Firearms

Simple Weapons	Cost	Damage	Weight	Ammunition/Magazine	Range	Additional Properties
Derringer (powder) ‡	15 gp	1d4 piercing	1 lb.	Powder (muzzleloading)	20/100	Light, reload 1
Musket, rifled (aka, longrifle)	60 gp	1d12 piercing	15 lbs.	Powder (muzzleloading)	80/800	Heavy, reload 1, two-handed
Martial Weapons						
Air reservoir rifle	100 gp	1d12 piercing	10 lbs.	Special (internal)	60/600	Recharge 20, special, two-handed
Pepperbox, heavy	50 gp	1d6 piercing	4 lbs.	Powder (internal)	20/100	Loading, reload 12
Pepperbox, light †	30 gp	1d6 piercing	2 lbs.	Powder (internal)	20/100	Loading, reload 4

Table 2.4—Early Industrial Firearms

Simple Weapons	Cost	Damage	Weight	Ammunition/Magazine	Range	Additional Properties
Derringer (handgun) ‡	20 gp	1d4 piercing	1 lbs.	Handgun rounds (internal)	20/100	Light, reload 2
Revolver, light (handgun) ‡	30 gp	1d6 piercing	2 lbs.	Handgun rounds (internal)	30/150	Reload 6
Rifle, breech-loading	90 gp	2d6 piercing	9 lbs.	Rifle rounds (internal)	80/800	Loading, two-handed
Shotgun, double-barreled	90 gp	2d8 piercing	8 lbs.	Shotshells (internal)	50/200	Rapid-fire, reload 2, scattershot, two-handed
Martial Weapons						
Revolver, heavy (handgun)	50 gp	1d8 piercing	3 lbs.	Handgun rounds (internal)	40/200	Heavy, reload 6
Rifle, repeating †	120 gp	2d6 piercing	10 lbs.	Rifle rounds (internal)	80/800	Reload 10, two-handed
Shotgun, sawn-off or coach	95 gp	2d6 piercing	6 lbs.	Shotshells (internal)	30/120	Rapid-fire, reload 2, scattershot, versatile (2d8)

Table 2.5—High Industrial Firearms

Simple Weapons	Cost	Damage	Weight	Ammunition/Magazine	Range	Additional Properties
Air pistol ‡	10 gp	1d3 piercing	2 lbs.	Airgun pellets (internal)	30/150	Loading
Air rifle	25 gp	1d3 piercing	6 lbs.	Airgun pellets (internal)	40/400	Loading, two-handed
Handgun, light semi-auto ‡	80 gp	1d8 piercing	2 lbs.	Handgun rounds (removable)	30/150	Light, rapid-fire, reload 8
Paintball marker	40 gp	1 bludgeoning	4 lbs.	Paintballs (internal)	40/160	Non-lethal, rapid-fire, reload 200, two-handed
Shotgun, repeating	120 gp	2d8 piercing	6 lbs.	Shotshells (internal)	50/200	Reload 6, scattershot, two-handed
Snake gun ‡	60 gp	2d4 piercing	2 lbs.	Shotshells (internal)	15/60	Reload 1, scattershot
Martial Weapons						
Flamethrower, conventional	300 gp	3d8 fire	40 lbs.	Petrol/propellant (removable)	50/200	Heavy, reload 12, special, spray, two-handed
Flechette rifle	100 gp	1d4 piercing	6 lbs.	Flechette rounds (removable)	60/600	Rapid-fire, reload 30, two-handed
Handgun, heavy semi-auto	150 gp	1d10 piercing	3 lbs.	Handgun rounds (removable)	40/200	Rapid-fire, reload 10
Machine gun	400 gp	1d12 piercing	20 lbs.	Rifle rounds (removable)	100/1000	Heavy, rapid-fire, reload 50, spray, two-handed
Machine pistol (handgun)	200 gp	1d8 piercing	3 lbs.	Handgun rounds (removable)	30/150	Rapid-fire, reload 15, spray
Rifle, semiautomatic †	200 gp	1d10 piercing	7 lbs.	Rifle rounds (removable)	60/600	Rapid-fire, reload 20, two-handed
Rifle, sniper †	350 gp	2d8 piercing	9 lbs.	Rifle rounds (internal)	200/2000	Heavy, loading, two-handed
Submachine gun	250 gp	1d10 piercing	8 lbs.	Handgun rounds (removable)	40/400	Rapid-fire, reload 25, spray, two-handed

Table 2.6—Proto-Energy Age Firearms

Simple Weapons	Cost	Damage	Weight	Ammunition/Magazine	Range	Additional Properties
Chiller rifle	180 gp	1d8 cold	12 lbs.	Fuel cell (removable)	20/80	Heavy, reload 20, special
Flechette pistol ‡	150 gp	1d4 piercing	2 lbs.	Flechette rds. (removable)	60/300	Light, rapid-fire, reload 30
Sleeper pistol ‡	100 gp	1d6 poison +	2 lbs.	Pistol cell (removable)	30/150	Light, non-lethal, rapid-fire, reload 8
Stinger pistol ‡	100 gp	1d6 acid	3 lbs.	Pistol cell (removable)	30/150	Reload 20, spray
Martial Weapons						
Flamethrower, advanced	300 gp	2d8 fire	15 lbs.	Fuel cell (removable)	10/40	Heavy, reload 20, spray, two-handed
Gauss rifle (aka, railgun)	400 gp	2d10 piercing	25 lbs.	Gauss mag (removable)	300/3000	Heavy, loading, reload 5, two-handed
Goliath pistol	250 gp	1d12 piercing	5 lbs.	Rifle rounds (removable)	50/250	Heavy, reload 10
Guided rifle	500 gp	1d10 piercing	8 lbs.	Smart rounds (removable)	100/1000	Rapid-fire, reload 20, special, two-handed
Ion rifle	300 gp	1d8 lightning +	6 lbs.	Rifle cell (removable)	50/500	Reload 10, special, two-handed
Pain rifle (aka, maser) †	250 gp	1d10 psychic	18 lbs.	Rifle cell (removable)	60/240	Heavy, non-lethal, reload 5, special, two-handed
Particle beam thrower	1500 gp	2d8 radiant	50 lbs.	*Integrated*	20/200	Heavy, recharge 5, special, two-handed
Razor launcher	150gp	1d8 slashing	7 lbs.	Razor discs (internal)	40/160	Heavy, reload 4, two-handed
Secret pistol †	60 gp	1d4 piercing	+1 lb.	Handgun rounds (internal)	20/100	Light, reload 1, special
Shotgun, automatic	200 gp	2d8 piercing	12 lbs.	Shotshells (removable)	50/200	Reload 10, scattershot, spray, two-handed
Sonic rifle	220 gp	1d8 thunder +	12 lbs.	Rifle cell (removable)	30/120	Non-lethal, reload 10, special, two-handed

Table 2.7—Advanced Energy Age Firearms

Simple Weapons	Cost	Damage	Wt.	Ammunition/Mag.	Range	Additional Properties
Blaster pistol, light ‡	100 gp	1d6 lightning	2 lbs.	Pistol cell (removable)	40/200	Light, reload 10
Disruption pistol ‡	250 gp	2d4 necrotic	3 lbs.	*Integrated*	50/250	Recharge 20, special
Laser pistol, light ‡	80 gp	1d4 fire	1 lb.	Pistol cell (removable)	80/400	Light, reload 12
Phase pistol ‡	200 gp	1d8 force	1 lb.	*Integrated*	50/250	Non-lethal, recharge 20, special
Martial Weapons						
Antimatter rifle	600 gp	2d12 necrotic	15 lbs.	Rifle cell (removable)	25/250	Heavy, reload 5, scattershot, 2-handed
Auto-blaster	350 gp	1d10 lightning	12 lbs.	Rifle cell (removable)	60/600	Rapid-fire, reload 20, spray, 2-handed
Auto-laser	250 gp	1d8 fire	10 lbs.	Rifle cell (removable)	400/4000	Rapid-fire, reload 20, spray, 2-handed
Barrage fusillade gun	500 gp	3d6 piercing	30 lbs.	Rifle rds. (removable)	50/500	Reload 30, spray, two-handed
Blaster pistol, heavy †	130 gp	1d8 lightning	4 lbs.	Pistol cell (removable)	40/200	Rapid-fire, reload 20
Blaster rifle	250 gp	1d12 lightning	10 lbs.	Rifle cell (removable)	60/600	Rapid-fire, reload 20, two-handed
Blaster rifle, chain	700 gp	1d10 lightning	10 lbs.	Rifle cell (removable)	60/600	Reload 12, special, two-handed
Disruption rifle	400 gp	2d6 necrotic	8 lbs.	*Integrated*	80/800	Recharge 30, special, two-handed
Graviton rifle †	300 gp	1d10 bludgeoning	12 lbs.	Rifle cell (removable)	40/400	Reload 10, special, two-handed
Laser pistol, heavy †	100 gp	1d6 fire	3 lbs.	Pistol cell (removable)	100/500	Rapid-fire, reload 20
Laser rifle	175 gp	1d10 fire	8 lbs.	Rifle cell (removable)	400/4000	Rapid-fire, reload 20, two-handed
Phase rifle	350 gp	1d12 force	7 lbs.	*Integrated*	80/800	Non-lethal, recharge 30, special, 2-hand
Plasma rifle	500 gp	2d8 radiant	9 lbs.	Rifle cell (removable)	100/400	Heavy, reload 10, scattershot, 2-handed
Reaper rifle †	200 gp	1d12 slashing	7 lbs.	Rifle cell (removable)	50/200	Reload 6, scattershot, special, 2-handed

Special Weapons

Weapons with the **special** property are described below.

Air reservoir rifle. This weapon's Recharge property represents time spent pumping the reservoir. You can instead swap in a spare fresh reservoir as an action.

Chiller rifle. This modified firefighting gear sprays a concentrated stream of supercooled liquid at the target. It puts out small non-magical fires on contact.

Disruption pistol/rifle. Disruption firearms shoot a ray of energy that disrupts molecular bonds, causing matter to disintegrate. If a creature or object is reduced to 0 hit points by a disruption pistol or rifle it is reduced to a pile of fine dust. A disintegrated creature can only be restored to life by either the spell true resurrection or wish. Because of this effect, disruption weapons are often banned in civilized societies.

Flamethrower, conventional. This military weapon expels a burning liquid fuel to light targets on fire. A creature hit by a petrol-fueled flamethrower must make a Dexterity saving throw DC 15 at the beginning of each of its turns to extinguish the flames or continue to burn for an additional 2d8 fire damage.

Graviton rifle. A graviton rifle crushes its target by momentarily increasing their effective weight. When hit, the target must make a Strength saving throw with a DC equal to 8 plus the amount of damage dealt. On a failed save, the target falls prone.

Guided rifle. Using an on-board camera with visual tracking software and enhanced gyroscopic ammunition, this high-tech weapon system allows the wielder to use a bonus action to choose a target they can see. The designated target is treated as having one step less cover than they otherwise would—half cover becomes no cover, and three-quarters cover becomes half cover. Total cover is unaffected.

Ion rifle. The ion rifle, also known as a lightning gun or shock rifle, is an early energy weapon. By accelerating ionized particles at a target, it can deliver a powerful electrical bolt along that path. A creature hit by this attack must make a Constitution saving throw with a DC equal to 8 plus the damage dealt or become stunned until the end of its next turn. Metallic constructs and creatures wearing metal armor have disadvantage on this saving throw.

Pain rifle. This type of non-lethal weapon uses a high-power long-wave radiation beam (known as a MASER) to cause intense pain in the target. On a critical hit, the target suffers one level of exhaustion, in addition to the increased damage.

Particle beam thrower. A particle beam thrower is similar in design to a flamethrower, having a gun connected by a hose to a small particle accelerator worn on the user's back. On a successful hit, if the target is an undead or fiend, you may try to initiate a grapple using the beam. As a bonus action, make a Strength (athletics) check opposed by the target's Strength (athletics) or Dexterity (acrobatics) check to drag the grappled creature up to 30 feet in any direction. While any creature stays grappled by your particle beam, you cannot make attacks with the weapon.

Phase pistol/rifle. The phase pistol and phase rifle have two settings: non-lethal or kill. The non-lethal setting knocks out creatures that are reduced to 0 hp, as per the non-lethal weapon property. The "kill" setting removes the non-lethal property, dealing damage as a normal ranged weapon. Switching between settings is an object interaction.

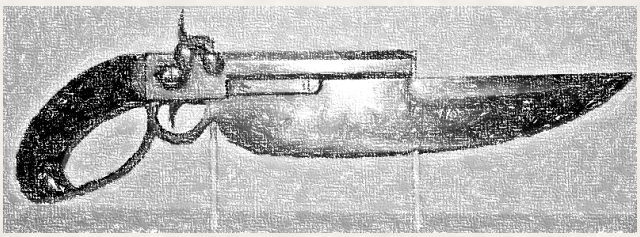
Reaper rifle. This unusual weapon fires a thin fan of energy. On a critical hit, your attack may hit an additional target. Choose one target adjacent to the first and make a separate attack roll against it.

Secret pistol. These covert weapons are custom built into other equipment. Walking sticks and wrist cuffs are common choices. Recognizing the object as a weapon is extremely difficult, and any attempt to spot or search for a secret pistol is made with disadvantage. Reloading these weapons is somewhat difficult, and always takes an action.

Sleeper pistol. This non-lethal weapon fires a contact poison which may debilitate the target on a successful hit. A target that takes damage must make a Constitution saving throw with a DC equal to 8 plus the damage dealt or become incapacitated. They may repeat this saving throw at DC 10 at the beginning of each of their turns to end the condition. Creatures with less than 20 hit points have disadvantage on the saving throws, while creatures with more than 60 hit points have advantage.

Sonic rifle. Attacks with this non-lethal weapon ignore the effects of cover, except for total cover. Any creature damaged by a sonic rifle's thunder damage is deafened for a number of rounds equal to the damage dealt. Deafened creatures have resistance to thunder damage from a sonic rifle.

Sword musket. The sword musket is a hybrid weapon, consisting of a muzzleloading pistol with a short sword blade mounted parallel to the gun barrel. You can make a ranged attack with the loaded firearm or make a melee attack with the blade. The blade deals 1d4 piercing damage. When you use the Attack action to make a melee attack with a loaded sword gun's blade and you hit, you may take a bonus action to fire the pistol at the same creature. Being within 5 feet of a hostile creature doesn't impose disadvantage on this special attack.



Types of Ammunition

Each weapon in the preceding tables requires a specific type of ammunition to make its attacks, as noted in the "Ammunition/Magazine" column. The following table has standard prices for each ammunition type. The most common types are listed first, with unusual types that are used with just a few weapons listed afterwards.

Some types of firearm ammunition involve multiple components—black powder and lead bullets, for example, or the gauss rifle's power cell and ferrous bolts. These have been simplified into a single item, so that you don't have to worry about tracking them separately. Just buy the listed ammunition and assume that both parts are always used at the same rate.

Table 2.8—Standard Ammunition

Common types	Cost	Weight
Handgun rounds (20)	3 gp	1/4 lb.
Pistol power cell *	2 gp	1/4 lb.
Powder with rounds (20)	6 gp	2 lbs.
Rifle power cell *	3 gp	1/2 lb.
Rifle rounds (20)	4 gp	1/2 lb.
Shotshells (12)	3 gp	1 lb.
Uncommon types		
Air reservoir with pump (20 shots)	15 gp	3 lbs.
Airgun pellets (100)	1 sp	1/2 lb.
Flechette rounds (30)	2 gp	1/4 lb.
Fuel cell *	5 gp	2 lbs.
Gauss mag (power cell and bolts) *	5 gp	1 lb.
Guided rounds (20)	20 gp	1 lb.
Paintballs (200)	2 gp	2 lbs.
Petrol and propellant tanks *	12 gp	30 lbs.
Razor discs (4)	1 gp	1/2 lb.

** Power cells and fuel cells/tanks are depleted after the number of shots specified by each weapon's reload property.*

Specialty Ammunition

Some ammunition can be upgraded to add special properties to an attack. The following table lists specialty ammunition and shows what type of standard ammunition it modifies or replaces. For many types, the cost and weight are given as modifiers to the standard ammunition rather than as flat figures.

Table 2.9—Specialty Ammunition

Special type	Modifies...	Cost	Weight
Acid-filled (20)	Paintballs	250 gp	1/5 lb.
Armor piercing	High Industrial rounds	×5	—
Baton rounds	High Industrial rounds or shells	×2	—
Blank cartridges	Any Early Industrial or later round or shell	×1/2	—
Exploding rounds	Proto-Energy Age rounds	×100	—
Hollow-point	Any Early Industrial or later round	×3	—
Holy water–filled (20)	Paintballs	250 gp	1/5 lb.
Incendiary	High Industrial rifle rounds or shotshells	×50	—
Pepper balls (20)	Paintballs	5 gp	1/5 lb.
Shotgun slugs (12)	Shotshells	5 gp	1 lb.
Silvered	Any round, shell, or pellet	+100 gp (per 10)	—
Tracer rounds	High Industrial rifle rds.	×3	—

Acid-filled paintballs. While loaded with this modified ammunition, a paintball marker loses its non-lethal property. Paintballs filled with acid deal 1d6 acid damage instead of the normal damage.

Armor piercing rounds. These bullets are specially designed to penetrate the materials used in modern ballistic armors. A weapon loaded with them bypasses resistance to piercing damage.

Baton rounds. Also known as rubber bullets or beanbag rounds, a weapon loaded with this category of ammunition gains the non-lethal property. Baton rounds are made for a variety of weapons, including handguns, rifles, and shotguns. A weapon with the spray property may not be loaded with these rounds, since the high-speed mechanisms would jam on this softer ammunition.

Blank cartridges. Blanks are ammunition cartridges containing gunpowder but no projectile. A weapon loaded with them, when fired, sounds and looks like a normal shot, but deals no damage. This "fake" ammunition is ideal for acting, subterfuge, and signaling.

Exploding rounds. These rounds explode when striking any target, dealing an additional 2d10 damage to the target and everything in a 5 ft radius. Creatures in the radius can make a DC 13 Dex save to take half damage. When applied to guided rounds, the target can be a point in space that you can see, rather than a creature or object.

Hollow-point rounds. When you score a critical hit with a hollow-point round, the weapon deals its maximum damage.

Holy water–filled paintballs. If a fiend or undead is struck by this ammunition, it takes 1d6 radiant damage (which is *not* non-lethal). Otherwise, it deals damage as normal for a paintball marker.

Incendiary rounds. Incendiary rounds deal an extra 1d10 fire damage which ignores fire resistance due to their incredible heat.

Pepper balls. When fired from a paintball marker, this irritant-filled ammunition deals 1d3 non-lethal poison damage in place of the usual damage. On a hit, the target must also make a Dexterity saving throw (DC 14) or become blinded for 1d6 rounds.

Shotgun slugs. This alternative ammunition allows a shotgun to function more like a rifle. A shotgun loaded with slugs rather than shells loses the scattershot property.

Silvered ammunition. Some monsters that have immunity or resistance to nonmagical weapons are susceptible to silver weapons. You can silver ten pieces of ammunition for 100 gp. This cost includes not only the price of the silver, but the time and expertise needed to add silver to the projectile without making it less effective.

Tracer rounds. Whenever you attack a creature and miss with tracer rounds, you gain advantage on your next attack roll against the same target. In addition, the flash of light from these rounds reveals the current position of both you and your target to anyone who can see.

Armor and Shields

Historically, the widespread use of firearms on the battlefield led first to some attempts at making heavier armors, but that arms race was shortly abandoned. Firearms can puncture all but the thickest plate, and any steel thick enough to stop a musket ball quickly became too heavy to wear.

However, Fifth Edition D&D doesn't have a core system for armor-defeating attacks, and with good reason. Having to keep track of more than one AC can be tedious and slow play. For that reason, Smoke & Thunder assumes that armor works as intended against firearm attacks. Armors that are specially designed to diffuse the impact of a bullet have relatively low ACs but provide resistance to piercing damage instead.

The table below groups armors and shields by era (for those that present new options). The armor proficiency needed for each type is indicated next to its name.

Resistance. Armors designed to protect the wearer from firearm attacks give the wearer resistance to certain damage types, usually nonmagical piercing damage.

Renaissance Armor

By the Renaissance, full-body armors were phased out in favor of heavier plating to cover only the vital organs.

Shot-proofed breastplate. This sturdy breastplate, expertly crafted from superior steel, grants its wearer resistance to piercing damage. Although it counts as medium armor, it is extraordinarily heavy to wear. Proofed breastplates can be visually identified by the bullet dimple left when the armor is quality tested at close range.

High Industrial Armor

For centuries, armor was relegated to largely decorative and ceremonial roles. Eventually, alternative materials arose, and after some time largely missing from the battlefield, modern body armors emerged.

Bulletproof vest. A bulletproof vest may be worn and concealed underneath other armor or clothing.

Riot armor. Made from plastic and composite materials, riot armor is a form of heavy padding most used by law enforcement.

Flak jacket. This armor consists of steel plates sewn into a bulky jacket or vest, which also incorporates many small pockets and attachment points for carrying ammunition, grenades, or other tiny items where they can be quickly reached.

Ceramic body armor. This armor, typically used by modern military and tactical law enforcement, incorporates heavy ceramic plates into its torso to help stop projectiles and flying debris.

Riot shield. A riot shield is made either from aluminum, often with a small window, or from clear polycarbonate. This design makes the shield somewhat less cumbersome than a traditional shield. While using a riot shield, when you attack with a light weapon, you may use the shield to make a shove attack as a bonus action.

Proto–Energy Age Armor

Near-future science-fiction presents some rather outlandish designs for armor. Whether light and concealable or massive and powered, near future armors tend to do more than just protect.

Table 2.10—Armor By Era

Name (and Proficiency)	Cost	Armor Class	Resistance	Strength	Stealth	Weight
Renaissance Era						
Shot-proofed breastplate (medium)	600 gp	14 + Dex modifier (max 2)	Piercing	Str 13	—	35 lbs.
High Industrial Era						
Bulletproof vest (light)	200 gp	11 + Dex modifier	Piercing	—	—	10 lbs.
Riot armor (light)	35 gp	12 + Dex modifier	—	—	Disadvantage	15 lbs.
Flak jacket (medium)	400 gp	13 + Dex modifier (max 2)	Piercing	—	Disadvantage	12 lbs.
Ceramic body armor (heavy)	1000 gp	15	Piercing and slashing	—	Disadvantage	20 lbs.
Riot shield (shield)	20 gp	+2	—	—	—	5 lbs.
Proto-Energy Age						
Nano armor (light)	300 gp	12 + Dex modifier	—	—	Advantage	4 lbs.
Agile power armor (medium)	2000 gp	16 + Dex modifier (max 2)	—	—	—	200 lbs.
Heavy power armor (heavy)	4000 gp	20	—	—	Disadvantage	1200 lbs.
Lenticular shield (shield)	30 gp	+2	—	—	—	5 lbs.
Advanced Energy Age						
Combat suit (medium)	500 gp	13 + Dex modifier (max 2)	Fire or lightning	—	—	30 lbs.
Battle suit (heavy)	2000 gp	15	Fire or lightning, plus necrotic	Str 13	Disadvantage	60 lbs.
Force cuff (shield)	50 gp	+2	Force	—	—	2 lbs.

Nano armor. This full bodysuit is made from an advanced cloth-like material that is extremely resilient and protects the wearer yet moves as fluidly as regular clothes. If you are not wearing other armor or carrying a shield, you gain advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks.

Agile power armor. This suit combines metal plating and advanced polymers for protection with servo motors and actuators to aid the wearer in strength and agility. While wearing this power armor, your Strength increases to 18, and you have advantage on Strength (athletics) and Dexterity (acrobatics) checks. The suit supports its own weight, so it does not contribute to your encumbrance.

Heavy power armor. This massive contraption fully encases the wearer in heavy plating and would be completely immovable if not for its piston-driven joints. Some models have transparent visors to see through, but many rely on electronic displays in front of the wearer's eyes to see out. While wearing heavy power armor, your strength is 20, and you have advantage on Strength-based ability checks and saving throws. You also count as one size larger when determining carrying capacity. The suit supports its own weight, so it does not contribute to your encumbrance.

Lenticular shield. This polycarbonate shield refracts light in such a way that it blends into the wielder's surroundings, making a person behind it nearly invisible. As a bonus action while wielding this shield, you can position it in such a way that it is possible to hide behind it.

Advanced Energy Age Armor

With the dominance of energy-based weapons, defending against energy attacks becomes more important than stopping projectiles. These armors all help wearers resist one or more types of energy damage.

Combat suit. This relatively light shell consists of close-fitting plates of advanced materials that help deflect both solid and energy attacks. It comes in two typical varieties, granting you resistance to either fire or lightning damage.

Battle suit. A somewhat bulkier version of the combat suit, this armor provides resistance to necrotic damage (such as from antimatter and disruption weapons), in addition to either fire or lightning damage.

Force cuff. This high-tech bracer projects a shimmering energy shield to block attacks as needed. When not active, only the physical bracer is visible.

Support Gear

With firearms comes a host of supporting equipment. This section describes items that have special rules or require further description. See the full table on the following page.

Bandolier. A bandolier is a belt, usually made of leather or another sturdy material, designed to hold pistols, loose bullets or shotshells, and possibly weapon sheaths or holsters for convenient access. It can be worn at the waist or across the chest. One will hold as many as 3 pistols, or approximately 40 bullets or two dozen shotgun shells.

Bayonet. As an action, this spike or dagger-like blade can be affixed to the muzzle end of a musket or rifle barrel, allowing the wielder of the firearm to make two-handed melee attacks that deal 1d6 + Str modifier damage.

Biometric trigger lock. This weapon upgrade reads the wielder's fingerprint, body chemistry, or other biological markers to prevent anyone but the owner or an authorized user from firing it. Authorized users may either be one or more specific individuals or all members of a species, such as human, elf, or orc. Initial calibration for a new user or species takes one minute, and requires a passcode supplied with the item. Removing a user also requires the passcode.

Bipod. A bipod is a short, two-legged stand for steadying the barrel of a two-handed firearm. It can be mounted to any rifle or machine gun, and when not in use it easily folds away. A firearm with a bipod may be used to attack while prone without incurring the usual disadvantage on the attack roll.

Black powder (keg). Large volumes of black powder are usually transported in small, wooden kegs, and then dispensed into powder flasks for personal use. A full keg holds about 400 charges. If exposed to any significant source of flame, a powder keg explodes, dealing 3d10 bludgeoning damage in a 15 ft radius. Creatures can make DC 16 Dexterity saving throw to take half damage.

Bump stock. This upgrade replaces the stock of any two-handed firearm with the rapid-fire property. Doing so adds the spray property to the weapon.

Corner stock. A corner stock upgrades a one-handed firearm to allow shooting around corners using a periscopic sight. The attached handgun becomes two-handed and can make attacks around an adjacent corner while allowing you to retain full cover.

Dueling set. This matched pair of fine, muzzleloading pistols comes in a silk-lined wooden box, which also holds an ornate powder flask and gun cleaning supplies. It comes with 20 shots worth of powder and balls.

Electronic weapon tools. A set of tools for repairing and maintaining electronic weapons.

Flare gun. A signaling device. When fired, a flare provides bright light in a 10-foot radius and dim light for an additional 10 feet until the end of your next turn. If used as an improvised weapon, it has a range of 30 ft and deals 1d4 fire damage on a hit, then continues to burn the target for an additional 2d4 fire damage at the beginning of your next turn, unless the struck creature uses an action to put it out.

Ghillie suit. This full body suit is covered with fabric strips, yarn, threads, or other forms of simulated vegetation that camouflages the wearer's shape in a natural environment. When worn in a suitable area, the suit grants the wearer advantage on Dexterity (stealth) checks to hide while standing or lying still.

Gun case. This portable box is designed to hold a firearm and its accessories securely. It has a built-in combination lock.

Gun safe. A heavy safe designed to hold several firearms.

Gunsmith's tools. This kit includes all the tools necessary to craft and maintain firearms and their ammunition. The exact contents vary by era. This does not include the crafting of black powder or gunpowder, which requires the use of alchemist's tools.

Laser sight. When mounted to a firearm or other ranged weapon, this upgrade aids in aiming under difficult conditions by projecting a visible dot of colored light onto the target. When attacking with disadvantage, a

laser sight grants a +2 bonus on the attack roll. The laser may be turned on or off as an object interaction.

Night vision goggles. These electronic lenses grant the wearer darkvision to 120 feet. Donning or removing the goggles takes an action. The wearer is blinded while exposed to bright light and until the end of their next turn afterwards.

Pepper spray. This tiny canister fits easily in a pocket. It contains a chemical that is extremely irritating to skin, eyes, and nostrils. As an action, the spray shoots up to 15 feet, dealing 2d4 non-lethal poison damage to a single creature. If damaged, the target must also make a Constitution saving throw or become blinded. The DC of the saving throw is 8 + the damage dealt. The blinded creature may repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns. Each canister holds 10 shots.

Powder flask/horn. Black powder is typically carried in a powder flask (also called a powder horn, depending on its material), a watertight container and for dispensing the powder for each shot. A flask holds up to 1 pound of black powder, which is enough charges (measured uses) for 100 shots. Powder flasks typically have a shoulder strap or belt hanger included. Ornate versions made from artfully carved bone or horn and richly detailed pewter or silver are available.

Powered exoskeleton. This device uses servos to aid the wearer in strenuous activities. While wearing this device, you count as one size larger when determining your carrying capacity and the weight you can push, drag, or lift. In addition, you have advantage on Constitution saving throws to avoid exhaustion.

Scope. A scope is a lens system that can be mounted on a firearm, allowing you to aim with greater accuracy. When you use a firearm with this upgrade to Ready an attack or take the Aim action (see "Combat Actions" in the "Optional Rules" chapter), the weapon's normal range is increased by the scope's multiplier.

Equipment Packs

You may want to save yourself time when equipping a character by purchasing one of these equipment packs instead of choosing items individually.

Sniper's Pack (480 gp). This pack contains firearm accessories useful for long range accuracy and concealment. Includes a bipod, gun case, scope (×4), and a silencer/suppressor.

Tactical Pack (410 gp). This pack consists of accessories commonly used in urban warfare and law enforcement. Includes a bulletproof vest, laser sight, scope (×2), tactical flashlight, and a utility vest.

Shoulder holster. Aids in concealing a one-handed firearm under a coat or jacket.

Silencer/suppressor. A silencer or suppressor disguises the flash and noise of gunshots. As an action, you can connect a silencer to a handgun, rifle, or submachine gun. Ability checks made to recognize a silenced gunshot or to locate a shooter based on the sound of their silenced gunshots are made with disadvantage (or -5 to Passive Perception).

Slow match. A specially treated length of slow-burning braided cord which smolders when lit and can be safely hung from a belt without igniting normal clothes. It may be used to light powder, fuses, candles, and the like. A slow match will burn for a total of 5 minutes and may be snuffed out and saved for later.

Tactical flashlight. This flashlight may be attached beneath the barrel of a handgun, rifle, or submachine gun, directing light wherever the weapon is pointed. When turned on, it casts bright light in a 30-foot cone and dim light for an additional 30 feet.

Utility vest. This sturdy vest is made with many small pockets and attachment points for carrying Tiny items.

Table 2.11a—Weapon Upgrades

Item	Cost	Weight
High Industrial Era		
Bayonet	2 gp	1 lb.
Bipod	20 gp	1 lb.
Bump stock	100 gp	—
Corner stock	250 gp	3 lbs.
Laser sight	30 gp	—
Scope (×2, ×3, ×4)	100/200/400 gp	1/1½/2 lbs.
Night vision scope	+150 gp	+1/2 lb.
Silencer/suppressor	40 gp	1 lb.
Tactical flashlight	4 gp	—
Proto-Energy Age		
Biometric trigger lock	40 gp	—

Table 2.11b—Other Support Gear

Item	Cost	Weight
Late Medieval Era		
Black powder (keg, 400 shots)	100 gp	5 lbs.
Gunsmith's tools	40 gp	15 lbs.
Powder flask/horn (empty)	5 sp	1/2 lb.
Powder flask/horn, ornate	5 gp	1/2 lb.
Slow match	1 cp	1/4 lb.
Age of Empire		
Bandolier	2 gp	1 lb.
Dueling set	50 gp	8 lbs.
High Industrial Era		
Flare gun	10 gp	1 lb.
Flares (5)	5 sp	1/4 lb.
Ghillie suit	50 gp	7 lbs.
Gun case	15 gp	4 lbs.
Gun safe	150 gp	100 lbs.
Night vision goggles	400 gp	2 lbs.
Pepper spray	5 gp	1/4 lb.
Shoulder holster	4 gp	2 lbs.
Utility vest	6 gp	2 lbs.
Proto-Energy Age		
Electronic weapon tools	80 gp	5 lbs.
Powered exoskeleton	1200 gp	20 lb.

Chapter 3: Character Options

If you know the enemy and know yourself, you need not fear the result of a hundred battles. If you know yourself but not the enemy, for every victory gained you will also suffer a defeat. If you know neither the enemy nor yourself, you will succumb in every battle.

—Sun Tzu, *The Art of War*

Many fighting styles and feats for traditional ranged weapons work just as well with firearms. Below you'll find some additional options that take advantage of the unique properties and training associated with firearm combat.

New Fighting Styles

When you gain a fighting style from your class, you can choose from these additional fire-combat related options. Fighters may select from any of these added options. Paladins may select Gun-Slinging, Musketeer, or Reactive Fire. Rangers may select Marksmanship, Reactive Fire, or Sniping.

Gun-slinging. You add your proficiency bonus to initiative. In addition, while you are wielding a revolver in one hand and have the other hand free, it gains the rapid-fire property.

Marksmanship. When you roll a 1 or a 2 on an attack roll with a ranged weapon, you can reroll the die and must use the new roll, even if the new roll is a 1 or a 2.

Musketeer. While wielding a firearm, you get +1 to hit with melee weapon attacks.

Reactive fire. While wielding a loaded firearm, you can use your reaction to attack an opponent when they become visible (a condition making them invisible ends, including darkness or full cover) or when they move at least 10 feet towards you.

Sniping. When you attack with a ranged weapon while hidden, you do not automatically reveal your position. To avoid revealing your location, make a Dexterity (Stealth) check the first time that you make a ranged attack each round. Potential observers oppose this check with their passive Perception or may make an active Wisdom (Perception) check if they are directing their attention to locating the source of your attacks.

New Feats

These feats represent exceptional training with specific types of firearms or specialized fighting techniques using firearms in unexpected ways.

Autofire Expert

While wielding a weapon with the spray property, you can sweep side to side during a spray attack, changing the area effect from a line to a cone.

In addition, targets of your spray attacks have disadvantage on the saving throw.

Gun Fu

Prerequisite: Handgun Expert

You are highly trained at integrating firearms into close-quarters brawling. While you are grappling a target, you have advantage on one-handed firearm attacks against them.

In addition, you can wield the firearms you are proficient with as melee weapons, using the rules for a club for one-handed firearms and the rules for a greatclub for two-handed firearms.

Handgun Expert

Thanks to extensive practice with handguns, you gain the following benefits:

- You ignore the reload property of removable magazine firearms with which you are proficient.
- Being within 5 feet of a hostile creature doesn't impose disadvantage on your ranged attack rolls.
- When you use the Attack action and attack with a one-handed weapon, you can use a bonus action to attack with a handgun or pistol you are holding.

Rifle Master

You've learned to make the most of a weapon's range, allowing you to pick off foes quickly. You gain the following benefits:

- On your turn, when you score a critical hit with a ranged weapon or reduce a creature to 0 hit points with one, you can make one ranged weapon attack as a bonus action.
- While you are wielding a two-handed firearm, you can make melee attacks with the butt of the weapon. This attack uses your Strength modifier. The weapon's damage die for this attack is a d6, and it deals bludgeoning damage.
- While you are wielding a two-handed ranged weapon, other creatures provoke an opportunity attack from you when they move into the weapon's normal range.

Trick Shooting

Prerequisite: Intelligence 13 or higher

You have practiced the ability to shoot from odd positions and even change the angle of your shots by glancing bullets off stationary objects. When you make a firearm attack at a target behind cover and miss, you can reroll the attack, potentially turning it into a hit.

In addition, you can fire two-handed firearms with one hand.

Two Birds With One Stone

You are adept at catching multiple targets in the scatter of a single shot. When you attack with a scattershot weapon and hit, you may use a bonus action to make a second attack against a foe adjacent to the first, using no additional ammunition.

New Spells

The following spells are inspired by firearms, but some will work with any ranged weapon.

Arrest Missiles

2nd-level abjuration (arcane, divine)

Casting Time: 1 reaction, which you take when you are hit by a ranged weapon attack
Range: Self
Components: S
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute

An invisible barrier of magical force appears and protects you from ranged weapon attacks. Until the spell ends, all ranged weapon attacks that would hit you are stopped by the barrier, which takes damage from the attack instead. The barrier has hit points equal to double your spellcasting ability score plus your proficiency bonus. If the barrier is reduced to 0 hit points, you take any remaining damage and the spell ends.

At Higher Levels: When you cast this spell using a spell slot of 3rd level or higher, the range changes from self to a radius of 5 feet per slot level above 2nd, protecting all creatures in the area around you.

Cause Misfire

2nd-level abjuration (arcane)

Casting time: 1 reaction, which you take when a creature within 60 feet of you makes a firearm attack
Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S
Duration: Instantaneous

When a creature you can see within range makes a firearm attack, you make a halting gesture, foiling their attack. The weapon misfires, dealing 2d6 thunder damage to the target and making the firearm incapable of firing until they spend an action to clear the barrel.

At Higher Levels: When you cast this spell using a spell slot of 3rd level or higher, you may target one additional creature for each slot level above 2nd. The additional targets suffer the effects of the spell when they make a firearm attack before the beginning of your next turn.

Hail of Bullets

1st-level conjuration (arcane, divine)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: Self
Components: V, M (one piece of the weapon's ammunition, which is consumed by the spell)
Duration: Instantaneous

With a violent shout, you bring forth a shower of ammunition from a ranged weapon you are wielding. Each creature in a line the length of the weapon's normal range must make a Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, they take damage equal to the weapon's normal damage plus your spellcasting ability bonus.

Seeking Shot

3rd-level divination (arcane, primal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: Special
Components: V, M (a personal possession or piece of the target)
Duration: Concentration, up to 1 round

You touch a ranged weapon, wielded by you or an ally, causing the weapon to become attuned to the target creature's precise location. The next attack made with the weapon ignores both cover and invisibility affecting the target, provided that the spell hasn't ended and that there is a path at least one inch wide to the target. The path need not be straight or visible, so long as the target is within the weapon's range. The attack roll is made normally, applying disadvantage for long range if the straight-line distance to the target is greater than normal range.

Silver Bullet

1st-level transmutation (arcane, divine, primal)

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: Touch
Components: V, S, M (one silver piece, which is consumed by the spell)
Duration: 8 hours

You touch a ranged weapon, and for the duration attacks made with that weapon count as silvered ammunition for the purpose of overcoming damage resistance and immunity.

At Higher Levels: When you cast this spell using a spell slot of 2nd level or higher, you may target two additional weapons for each slot level above 1st.

Chapter 4: Optional Rules

The weapon properties and character options include a lot of added content. If you want rules for special situations that may arise, this chapter explores more possibilities.

Combat Actions

These two new combat actions are designed especially for firearm combat but can be used by anyone wielding a ranged weapon.

Aim

While wielding a ranged weapon, you focus your attention on a target that you can see within range. You gain advantage on your next attack with that weapon against the chosen target, as long as you do not move or take another action before the attack.

Provide Cover Fire

You protect an ally by using a ranged weapon to threaten their enemies. When you take this action, choose an ally. You must be wielding a loaded ranged weapon. Until the beginning of your next turn, each time the ally is attacked by a creature you can see, you may fire one piece of ammunition to grant them +2 to their AC. If your weapon has the spray property, you may instead spend 3 pieces of ammunition to grant them +5 to AC. If your weapon has the loading or reload properties, you can't use more ammunition this way than the weapon is loaded with. You may not use reactions until the start of your next turn.

Advanced Rules

If you want to add more detail to firearm combat, here are several more options similar in nature to the ones found in Chapter 9 of the *Dungeon Master's Guide*. Be careful about adding more than one or two new rules at a time, as many of them can add a lot of complexity and slow-down play.

Ballistics

Moving at incredible velocity, bullets focus a great amount of force into a tiny impact point, easily penetrating thin metal and even some walls. That power can be represented in a few ways.

Simple Ballistic Penetration

Due to the high velocity of their ammunition, firearms are adept at penetrating armor and even small amounts of cover. For a straightforward way to simulate this, all firearm attacks gain +2 to hit a creature wearing armor or a target behind either half or three-quarters cover.

Armor Defeating Firearms

Fifth Edition D&D does not have a mechanic for armor-defeating attacks. If you truly wish to simulate the ineffectiveness of most armors against firearms, then you'll want to bring back the idea of "Touch AC".

To calculate a target's touch AC, first determine their effective Dexterity modifier. Effective means that if their armor has a max Dex or no Dex bonus in its calculation, then that limitation applies to their Touch AC as well.

Shooting Through Cover

Sometimes barriers that would normally provide cover are not sturdy enough to stop a bullet. If a firearm attack would miss a target behind partial cover due to the AC bonus provided, you may check whether the bullet passes through the barrier to strike the target. If the attack roll would hit both the target's AC without the cover bonus and the AC of the material struck (see the following table from the DMG), roll the weapon's damage. Subtract the object's hit points from the damage rolled. If the resulting number is greater than 0, the attack hits, dealing the remaining damage to the target.

Cover AC and Hit Points

Cover Material	Armor Class (AC)	Cover Size (Thickness)	Hit Points
Cloth, paper, rope	11	Tiny (fence, window)	5
Crystal, glass, ice	13	Small (thin wall)	10
Wood, bone	15	Medium (thick wall)	18
Stone	17	Large (castle wall, outcropping)	27
Iron, steel	19		
Mithral	21		
Adamantine	23		

Stopping Power

When hit by a firearm attack, the target makes a Strength saving throw with a DC equal to the damage dealt. If they fail, they become Stunned until the end of their next turn. If they fail by 5 or more, they fall prone.

Soaking Damage

Alternatively, you can place the forceful effects of getting shot in the hands of the target. With this variant, when a character is hit by a firearm attack, they can choose to take a dramatic effect to reduce the amount of damage taken.

- Subtract 5 from the damage and fall prone.
- Subtract 10 from the damage and become incapacitated for one round.
- Subtract 20 from the damage and get knocked back 5 feet directly away from the attacker and become incapacitated for 1d6 rounds.

Stray Fire

In the chaos of combat, attacks don't always land where they're intended. Sometimes attacks are even directed to take advantage of this disorder.

Missed Targets

When a ranged weapon attack misses its intended target, you might want to know where it landed instead. In this case, draw a line (following the rules for a line area effect) from the attacker to the intended target, continuing out to the attack's maximum range. The first creature or object beyond the target that is within this area is potentially struck instead. Compare the attack roll to the AC of this new target to see if it is hit.

Human(oid) Shields
Creatures on the battlefield provide half cover to other targets beyond them, and it is possible to take advantage of that fact, whether through clever positioning or grappling a creature to force it into a covering position. If a ranged attack misses by 2 or less when a creature is providing cover to the intended target, the creature providing cover is potentially hit instead.

Volley Attacks
Sometimes one or both sides in a battle has a massed group of combatants, and targeting a specific foe is less important than hitting the other side, collectively. If the target group is composed more than half from individuals using the same stat block, the DM may allow ranged attacks to target the whole group. Such an attack gains advantage to target the shared AC number, and on a hit the target is decided randomly by the DM. Sneak Attacks and other precision-based damage and effects cannot be applied to such an attack.

Ammunition and Flexibility
Sometimes you just want to get the most out of the weapon you have.

Reloading Cartridges
With this variant rule, you can recover about half of your bullet casings and shotshells by taking a minute to Search the battlefield after combat. Using gunsmith's tools and a supply of gunpowder, you can reload the recovered shells and casings for one-tenth the cost of an equal amount of ammunition.

Improvised Pellets
With access to black powder, a muzzleloading weapon with the scattershot property can be loaded with gravel or similar in place of lead pellets. Rock salt may be used to add the non-lethal property to the attack.

The same may be done with shotshells, provided that the reloading cartridges rule, above, is also in effect. Ranges are halved.

Firearm Versatility
Most loaded weapons are capable of being fired one-handed. If the DM chooses to allow a character to shoot a two-handed firearm with one hand, the attack is made with disadvantage and reduces its damage die by one step.

Ranged Opportunity Attacks
While you are wielding a loaded ranged weapon, you can use your reaction to attack a creature you can see within the weapon's normal range. A weapon with the loading property is only considered loaded for this purpose if you did not attack with it on your most recent turn.

Damage Realism
I promised in the Introduction that we'd look at this. Damage is an abstraction, and I had hoped to convince you that firearms are nice and balanced at one die of damage, but it looks like you want more. So, here you go...

Higher Firearm Damage
If a DM and players wish to make guns more deadly and awe-inspiring, adding an extra die of damage to all the amounts given in Chapter 3 is an effortless way to achieve that. For example, a gun that's listed as 1d10 would deal 2d10, while one that's listed as 2d6 would increase to 3d6.

Point-Blank Range
When a firearm attack deals damage to a target within 10 feet, the attack deals maximum damage.

Less-lethal, Not Non-lethal
The non-lethal firearms in this book are based on the rules for non-lethal strikes found in the PHB. But real weapons that are designed to subdue rather than kill can and sometimes do inflict gruesome, even lethal damage. For this reason, these types of weapons are often classified as "less-lethal."

If you want to model this reality in your game, treat any critical hit or instance of massive damage as if the weapon lacks the non-lethal property. This means that a creature reduced to 0 hp by a "non-lethal" weapon in these circumstances is dying, just as with a typical attack, rather than falling unconscious but stable. For area effects that deal non-lethal damage, consider them lethal if the saving throw is failed by 10 or more.

Grittier Healing
If you really want a more realistic feel to damage, several variant rules in the DMG may be to your liking. Try out the Slow Natural Healing option or the Gritty Realism rest variant.

Environmental Hazards
Firearms, especially those in earlier eras, need to be maintained properly to function well or at all. Add to that the smoke produced by gunpowder prior to the modern era and atmospheric conditions start to be a real concern.

Moisture and Fouling
When firearms or gunpowder are exposed to wet conditions, they may become temporarily ineffective. If using this variant rule, when powder ammunition becomes wet, it is rendered useless until it is carefully dried out during a long rest. Likewise, firearms that use powder ammunition become unusable for one hour after immersion in water or spending ten minutes exposed to rain.

If a muzzleloading weapon isn't cleaned regularly during sustained use, it can become fouled. After every 5 shots, an action must be used to clean the barrel. Otherwise, the weapon acquires a 10% chance that each shot will misfire. On a misfire, the attack fails, and the weapon becomes unusable until it has been cleaned and repaired, which takes 10 rounds.

Underwater Targets
Water slows down bullets dramatically, effectively stopping them after a few feet. Treat any target underwater as having three-quarters cover from firearm attacks that deal piercing damage, and all attacks beyond normal range simply fail.

Flechette guns are immune to this variant rule.

Gunsmoke and Thunder
Prior to the relatively modern invention of smokeless powder, firearms were known not only for their loud

report but also for the smoke produced. With repeated shots, visibility could be significantly reduced.

The range at which firearm attacks can be heard varies by weapon and atmospheric conditions, but in an open space, one to two miles is a good estimate. Solid obstructions will reduce this distance significantly, while multiple weapons firing at once will raise the volume and therefore the distance to perhaps two to three miles.

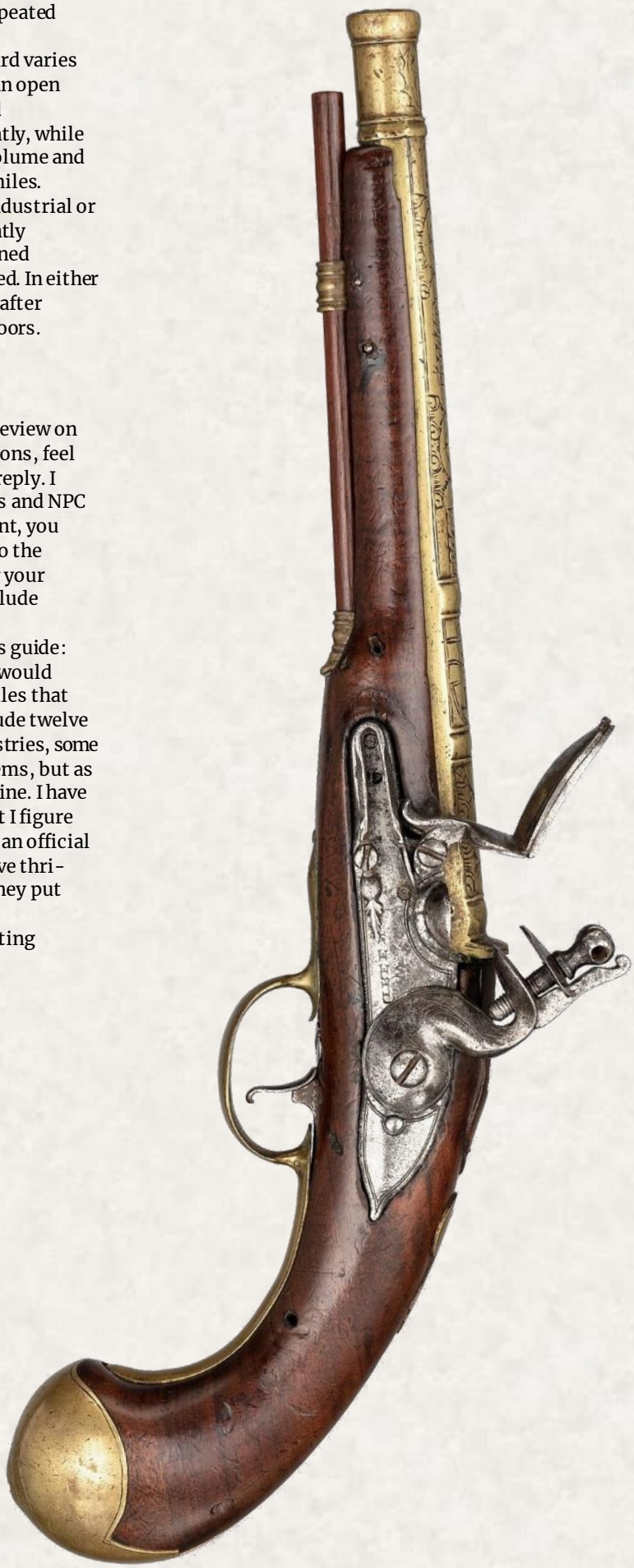
After one minute of combat involving Early Industrial or older firearms, the area of combat becomes lightly obscured by smoke. After five minutes of sustained combat, the battlefield becomes heavily obscured. In either case, The smoke will typically clear one minute after cessation of firing outdoors or five minutes indoors.

Afterword

If you liked this content, please leave a helpful review on the product page. If you have feedback or questions, feel free to leave a comment and I'll get back with a reply. I may expand Smoke & Thunder with magic items and NPC stat blocks soon. If you've purchased this content, you should be notified when there are any changes to the product files which will include a change log for your convenience. (Hint: the change log may also include special offers.)

I encourage you to check out the sequel to this guide: Smoke & Thunder 2: Explosives and Artillery. I would eventually like to complete the chronomancy rules that I've been brainstorming, in which I plan to include twelve subclasses, a couple of playable species or ancestries, some backgrounds, several spells, and a few magic items, but as of this writing those are little more than an outline. I have some vague notes for a psychic class as well, but I figure that Wizards must be getting close to finalizing an official psionics system sometime soon now that we have thri-kreen, so I'll probably hold off until I see what they put out. Oh, and an inventor class, maybe?

In other words, watch for more—I'm just getting started.



Firearms At Any Technology Level

Would you like to add guns to your medieval fantasy or Spelljammer campaign, or even run D&D in a modern or future setting, and need the weapon and gear stats to make it happen? Smoke & Thunder makes firearms available to all characters, regardless of class, across a wide range of time periods and genres. The rules inside make firearms formidable without making them the only practical choice of weapons.

In short, Smoke & Thunder balances all eras' weapons against each other—giving you guns that blow away the bad guys without blowing up your game!

WHAT'S INSIDE

- Firearms from five different historical periods, from late medieval to present day.

- Firearms for both near future and science fantasy genres, plus a sidebar on using them in steampunk settings.

- Rules for semiautomatic rapid-fire and fully automatic spray attacks.

- A bevy of accessories, from specialty ammo, to scopes, to bulletproof vests and high-tech armors.